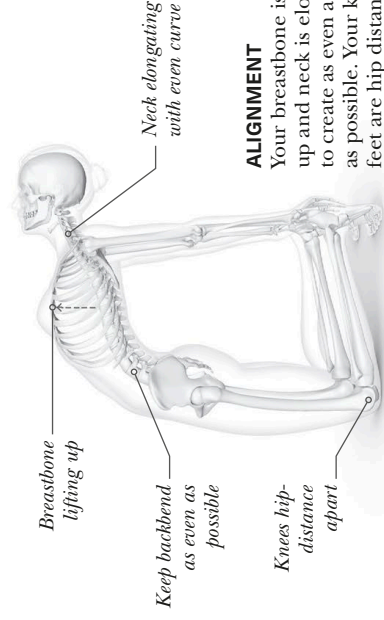


CAMEL

Ustrasana

Camel is an energetic backbend that can leave you feeling confident and ready to take on the day. This pose counteracts our flexion-driven modern lifestyles by broadening the chest. It is challenging but can be adapted for anyone who struggles to reach their feet.



ALIGNMENT

Your breastbone is lifting up and neck is elongating to create as even a backbend as possible. Your knees and feet are hip distance apart.

THE BIG PICTURE

The front of your body—including your abdominals and thighs—stretches, while the back of your body—including your back muscles, buttocks, and thighs—engages. You may also feel stretching on the soles of your feet as you tuck your toes under.

Neck

Your **cervical extensors** engage to extend your neck, while your **cervical flexors** stabilize, preventing your head from being thrown back, and creating an even, controlled curve.

Torso

Your **spinal extensors** engage to extend your spine while your **abdominals** stretch. Your **pectorals** stretch as you broaden your chest. Your **middle** and **lower trapezius** work with your **rhomboids** to retract and stabilize your scapulae, while your **serratus anterior** stretches.

Upper trapezius
Splenius muscles
Longus muscles
Sternocleidomastoid

Pectoralis major
Serratus anterior
Erector spinae
Spine
Quadratus lumborum
Rectus abdominis

